



REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS (RFP): LOCAL NEWS POLICY COALITION COORDINATOR

Purpose of Request

True North News Alliance seeks a consultant to serve as a coalition coordinator to support the coalition's organizing and mobilizing efforts into the 2027 legislative session and beyond. The alliance is focused on identifying and championing policy proposals that strengthen Minnesota's diverse local news and media ecosystem. This is a one-year commitment (November 2026 – November 2027) at this point with a maximum budget of \$50,000. The \$50,000 can be a grant to an organization or a contract with an individual. This money is intended to cover both a salary and individual expenses.

The coordinator will be responsible for planning, implementing, and evaluating activities associated with the coalition. This includes providing general oversight for coalition activities and associated projects; research and policy development, relationship management, and executing coalition meetings and schedules. The coordinator will also be tasked with engaging the coalition to develop a long-term plan for self-governance and sustainability. The workload will vary widely from week to week, depending on the season, ranging from 5-25 hours a week.

Responsibilities:

1. Report to Press Forward Minnesota leadership team and coalition leadership
2. Serve as coordinator for the coalition, managing activities such as:
 - a. Planning and facilitating coalition meetings, including preparing agendas and taking minutes.
 - b. Supporting the coalition in developing aligned policy proposals related to sustaining local news and media in Minnesota. This could include developing position statements, reviewing and recommending endorsements of policies, and supporting coalition members in advocating for policies/legislation at state levels.
 - c. Collaborating with local, state and national organizations focused on local news and information
3. Cultivate and manage complex relationships and partnerships to strengthen the coalition's efforts and build trust with important actors in the field. Ensure clear and transparent communication among members to promote collaboration, negotiation, and problem solving
4. Coordinate and facilitate coalition meetings, ensuring clear and transparent communication among members to promote collaboration, negotiation, and problem solving
5. Partner with the coalition members and lobbyists to develop legislative action aligned with the coalition's priorities including developing position statements, reviewing and recommending endorsements of policies, and supporting coalition members in advocating for policies/legislation at state levels.

September 2026

6. Recruit, engage, and maintain a diverse coalition membership with state and local partners

Prospective consultants are welcome to **contact Kayla Drake (kdrake@momentum-advocacy.com)** for more information.

RFP TIMELINE

September 24, 2026	RFP announced
October 26, 2026	Proposals due
October 26-November 6, 2026	Review of proposals, interviews and reference checks
November 9, 2026	We aim to select the consultant on or around November 9
November 16, 2026	We hope the consultant will be available to start by November 16
November 16, 2027	Expected conclusion of consulting engagement/deliverables due

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

True North News Alliance is a statewide alliance working to strengthen community-centered civic information and local news across Minnesota. The alliance brings together journalists, community leaders, media organizations, advocates, and partners who share a belief that access to trustworthy local information is essential to a healthy democracy and thriving communities.

This work is intentionally statewide. While Minnesota's communities differ by geography, culture, and media landscape, the challenges facing local news are deeply interconnected. When communities lose access to reliable, local information, civic participation declines, trust erodes, and public safety and accountability suffer. True North exists to create a shared advocacy space where both similarities and differences can inform stronger, more durable solutions.

True North News Alliance is collaborative, action-oriented, and grounded in public impact. Members are expected to engage in good faith, contribute their perspectives and expertise, and participate in shaping policy and strategy that can move beyond individual organizational interests toward shared outcomes for Minnesotans.

As True North News Alliance continues to grow and moves into its second year as a coalition, there is a need for sustained leadership in organizing the group moving into the 2027 Minnesota legislative session and beyond.

Anticipated outcomes of this role:

- A sustained and growing statewide local news coalition built on a strong foundation and aligned goals.
- Coalition membership that reflects the diversity of Minnesota's populations and the local news ecosystem
- Alignment on policy priorities for the 2027 legislative session
- A plan for sustained leadership and coalition structure moving forward

September 2026

QUALIFICATIONS + SERVICES REQUESTED

True North News Alliance seeks a consultant who brings the following to this engagement:

- Facilitation skills and ability to facilitate in in person and virtual settings
- Experience managing a coalition
- Skilled at conflict resolution
- Navigating multiple diverse perspectives and interests to achieve alignment
- Ability to engage with people and groups who represent a variety of roles and organizations
- Knowledge of and connection to Minnesota
- Transition planning related to coalition and organizational structure
- Understanding of advocacy, policy, and the legislative process is a plus

PROPOSAL SUBMISSION AND EVALUATION PROCESS

The True North News Alliance selection committee will review proposals and engage in further discussion with those that seem to be best aligned with the needs of the initiative. The Alliance is new, and this is the first role of its kind here. Part of the work will be defining what the role becomes, so if your background doesn't map neatly onto everything below, we still want to hear from you. We seek to understand the following information from prospective consultants, which can be presented by answering these questions directly and in this order, or another way, if preferred. Answers may be any length that best represents interest and experience. Proposals can be delivered in a word or pdf document, or a short video, attached to an email. Those who have barriers to providing their response in one of these formats may contact Kayla Drake (email below) to discuss alternatives.

1. Why are you interested in working on this project?
2. As the first person in this role, you will help shape both the Alliance and the position itself. What is your vision for the role, and what would you want it to become?
3. Share 1-3 examples of past work that you would draw upon for inspiration in this effort.
4. Explain your relationship with and/or understanding of local news and policy and how it has the potential to support and improve our communities.
5. Share the ways you bring diverse thoughts, perspectives and/or lived experience to this engagement, particularly in the areas of race/ethnicity; gender; sexual orientation; ability; rural geography.
6. Tell us how you will structure your fees and time for this project and, given the expectations of this engagement, what you estimate the cost to be. Note—the maximum budget for this engagement is \$50,000.
7. Feel free to add anything else that you wish to have considered.

Please deliver proposals to kdrake@momentum-advocacy.com and CC May Yang at myang@mcf.org.

SELECTION CRITERIA

Proposals will be evaluated by members of the True North News Alliance selection committee. Proposals are welcome from individuals or organizations who are based in Minnesota. All proposals will be evaluated using the same criteria, as follows:

- **Ability to Be Successful** — The True North News Alliance selection committee will consider the answers to common questions, and any other material prospective consultants wish to submit for consideration, to determine the ability to be successful in this engagement.
- **Media Ecosystem Knowledge** — We will consider familiarity with and connections across Minnesota's local news and civic information ecosystem, including relationships with journalists, media organizations, and community partners statewide.
- **Policy Interest** — We will consider demonstrated interest in and appetite for public policy and advocacy work, including understanding the Minnesota legislative process.
- **Alignment with Alliance Values** — True North News Alliance selection committee seeks candidates whose approach reflects the alliance's values: collaboration, equity, innovation, sustainability, and transparency.
- **References** — For those consultants most aligned with the needs of this project, we will contact three references provided by the prospective consultant. We may consider reputation, knowledge of prior work, and informal feedback from peers, when applicable.
- **Interviews** — True North News Alliance selection committee may conduct interviews as part of the selection process.

The decision to engage a particular consultant to work with True North News Alliance will be based on many factors detailed in the request for proposal. No single factor will determine the final decision.